Start: letters a m s t · lesson 5 of 8 · 50 minutes

a m s t Review: Roll and Cover

Today your child learns: I can say the sounds for a, m, s and t and find pictures that start with them.



Standards: RF.K.3a, RF.K.3b, RF.K.1d, RF.K.2, RF.K.1a, RF.K.1b, RF.K.1c, RF.K.1, L.K.1a, L.K.2c, 10.5 K.A, 10.5 K.B, 10.5 K.C. Common Core State Standards © 2010 NGA Center and CCSSO.

10′ Sounds · 3′ Letters · 20′ New · 7′ Read · 10′ Write

Today at a glance

10 min	Friday Check first at home; then sound games: step each word in sentences.
3 min	Letter drill: a m s t, small and capital; no check straight after it.
20 min	Roll and Cover: roll, say the sound, cover a picture starting with it.
7 min	Reading together: child points to each word in Hello, School!
10 min	Handwriting: form t and T from the top; trace and write first name.

Get ready (2 minutes)

- Print: Roll and Cover: a m s t
- Print: Friday Check: Week 1 (about 2 minutes per child, plus about 1 minute to record; at home first, before the letter drill; in class one child at a time, never straight after the drill)
- Print: Handwriting: t and My Name, day 5
- From the kit: a m s t letter cards, T t trace page; Hello, School! from day 1
- One die, 16 counters in 2 colors (coins or cereal), pencil, highlighter

Printing in black and white? The green start dot is the big dot.

Tip for the grown-up

Give the Friday Check before the letter drill (in class, one child at a time, never straight after the drill), and only tick during it; any sound not ticked goes first in Wednesday's letter drill. Keep the kit letter cards in an envelope; you will use them for all 3 weeks.



Short on time? At home in 20 minutes

1. Friday Check (3 min) at the start of the sitting, before the letter drill (about 2 minutes per child, plus about 1 minute to record): point to a m s t A M S T in a mixed order, ask 'What sound?' and tick each right one.
2. Sound games (3 min): say short sentences like 'Sam sat on a mat' and take one step per word together.
3. Letter cards (2 min): show the small letter cards first, then the capital cards, and say name, sound and key picture together, like 'a, /a/, apple'.
4. Roll and Cover (7 min): take turns rolling, saying the sound, naming a picture that starts with it and covering it.
5. Handwriting (5 min): say the path as your child traces 3 t and 3 T, writes one of each alone, then their first name.



SOUND GAMES

Sound games: words in a sentence

10 min

Hear that a spoken sentence is made of separate words, and count them.

Watch me I do it, you watch

SAY

Listen. Sam sat. Sam... sat. One finger for each word.

Two words! Now: Sam sat on a mat.

Sam, sat, on, a, mat. Five fingers. Five words!

- Say each sentence at normal speed, then slowly, lifting one finger per word.
- Ears only: no letters, no paper.

We do together

SAY

Our turn. Stand up. One step for each word.

I see the sun. I, see, the, sun. Four steps!

Mom has a map. Step it with me. How many?

- Step forward together, saying each word as you step; count the steps aloud.
- Keep sentences short: 2 to 5 words.

You do the child alone

SAY

Your turn. Step each word, then tell me how many.

Sam ate an apple. Six seals swim. The sun is hot.

- Answers: 4, 3, 4. Apple is one word, even with two claps.
- Time left? The child makes up a sentence; you step it together.

If your child gets it wrong

- Two steps for apple: 'Apple is one word. My turn... Our turn... Your turn.'
- Steps drift from words: step it slowly (My turn), hold hands (Our turn), then Your turn.



LETTER DRILL

Letter drill: a m s t

3 min

Say the name, sound and key picture for a, m, s and t, small and capital, quickly.

Watch me I do it, you watch

SAY

Watch me. a, /a/, apple. m, /m/, map.

s, /s/, sun. t, /t/, top.

/t/ is quick and quiet. No 'uh'.

- Hold up the small letter cards first, then the capital cards: name, sound, key picture.
- Hold /m/ like a hum and /s/ like a hiss; whisper /t/ once.

We do together

SAY

Say it with me: name, sound, picture.

Now the capital cards. A, /a/, apple.

- Say all three together for a m s t, then repeat with the capital cards.
- Keep a brisk beat, about 5 seconds a card.

You do the child alone

SAY

Your turn. I'll mix them up. Name, sound, picture.

- Shuffle and show all 8 cards in a new order; the child answers alone.
- A card the child stalls on goes back in the pile twice more.

If your child gets it wrong

- 'tuh' or 'muh': 'My turn: /t/, quick, no tail. Our turn: /t/. Your turn.'
- Wrong name or sound: 'This is m. It says /m/, like map. Say it with me... Your turn.'



NEW SKILL

Review game: Roll and Cover

20 min

Roll, say the letter's sound, and cover a picture that starts with that sound.

Watch me I do it, you watch

SAY

Watch me. I rolled 3. Three is s. s says /s/.

Sun: /s/... sun. Sun starts with /s/. I cover the sun.

Roll 6? Roll again. Roll 5? I pick any letter.

- Point to the dice key on Roll and Cover, then the sun; put a counter on it.
- Stretch the first sound as you check a picture: /m/... oon, moon.

We do together

SAY

Our turn. You roll. Two is m. What sound?

/m/. Which picture starts with /m/? Moon? Map? Mouse? Mop?

Say it with me: /m/... map. Cover it!

- Take 2 or 3 shared turns: roll, say the sound, say the picture, cover.
- If a letter's four pictures are all covered, that roll is a free turn.

You do the child alone

SAY

Your turn. Roll, say the sound, say the picture, cover it.

We take turns until every picture is covered.

- Take turns, each with one counter color; say your own sound and picture aloud as a model.
- When all 16 are covered, count who covered more; play again if time is left.

If your child gets it wrong

- Wrong picture (tent for /s/): 'Listen: /t/... ent. Tent starts with /t/. Find one with /s/.'
- Says the letter name: 'That's its name. My turn: /s/. Our turn: /s/. Your turn.'



READING TOGETHER

Reading together: Hello, School!

7 min

Start at the top left, go left to right and top to bottom, and point to each word as the grown-up reads.

Watch me I do it, you watch

SAY

Watch my finger. I start here, at the top, on the left.

One tap for each word I read. Then back and down.

Hello, School! Two words. See the space between them?

- Tap under 'Hello', then 'School' on the cover; read 2 pages, tapping each word.
- At each line's end, sweep your finger back to the left and down.

We do together

SAY

Put your finger on mine. We tap each word together.

End of the line. Where do we go? Back and down!

- Read 3 more pages; the child's finger rides on yours, one tap per word.
- At each page turn, ask 'Which page comes next?' The child turns it.

You do the child alone

SAY

Your turn to be the pointer. Show me where to start.

I'll read. You tap one word each time I say one.

Can you find a letter you know: a, m, s or t?

- Read the last pages slowly as the child points alone; pause if taps and voice drift.
- The child points to one a, m, s or t and says its name.

If your child gets it wrong

- Starts on the right: 'My turn: top, left, here.' Guide their finger, then they try alone.
- Taps run ahead: 'One tap, one word. Our turn' (hand over hand), then reread the line.



HANDWRITING

Handwriting: t, T and my name

10 min

Form small t and capital T from the top, and write my first name with a capital first.

Watch me I do it, you watch

SAY

Pinch and flip. Sit tall. Watch me write small t, then capital T.

Start near the top line. Pull straight down. Cross at the middle line: slide right.

Start at the top line. Pull straight down. Back to the top: slide right across.

- Air-write both big, then write one of each on the kit T t trace page.
- Start small t near the top line; say each path as you write.

We do together

SAY

Write it in the air with me, big. Say the path.

Start near the top line. Pull straight down. Cross at the middle line: slide right.

Now we trace the first t and T together.

- Hand over hand, trace the first t and T on today's handwriting page, saying each path.
- Air-write capital T together too, saying its path from the trace page.

You do the child alone

SAY

Your turn. Trace 3, then write one alone from the green dot.

Say the path while you write.

Last row: trace your name, then write it. Capital first.

- Before the name row, write the child's first name in highlighter, capital first.
- Praise one exact thing: 'Your t started at the top.'

Letter paths: say these words as you write

T Start at the top line. Pull straight down. Back to the top: slide right across.

t Start near the top line. Pull straight down. Cross at the middle line: slide right.

If your child gets it wrong

- Starts at the bottom: 'Tops first. My turn' (write, saying the path), 'Our turn' (hand over hand), 'Your turn.'
- Cross on small t too high or low: point to the middle line: 'The cross sits here.'

Friday Check (about 2 minutes per child, plus about 1 minute to record)

1. Give Friday Check: Week 1 at home at the start of the sitting, before the letter drill, and in class one child at a time during the day, never straight after the letter drill.
2. Point to a, m, s, t, A, M, S, T in a mixed order and ask 'What sound?' for each (about 2 minutes per child).
3. Then take about 1 minute to record: tick each right sound on the child's row, write the total out of 8, and say only 'Thank you.'

Got it

8: Next week runs as planned: the start-of-year check first, then lesson 6 on Wednesday.

Nearly

6 or 7: Put each sound not ticked first in Wednesday's 3-minute letter drill, with its key picture.

Not yet

0 to 5: Same as Nearly, plus 3 extra minutes a day from Wednesday on the missed sounds, 2 at a time (in class a small group; at home just you and your child).